Mara’s Sealed Letter

Mara Vell
Blackwater Harbor Office

12 Lanternfall, 112 AL

Tessa,

Seven days have vanished from the memories of the crew who came ashore this morning. Nella Reed is waiting by the east quay; she remembers a bell beneath the water, and nothing after it.

Find Brother Orin before the Lantern Festival. Ask him why the chapel bell is ringing when the tide has swallowed its tower. Take the Saltglass Key from my office, but keep it wrapped until you reach the causeway.

Bring our people home before the festival bell sounds at dusk. The harbor will stand behind you.

Keep this quiet,

Mara Vell

Saltglass Key

A clue from Blackwater

Entrusted to Tessa by Mara Vell.

Saltglass Key

A translucent green key, warm to the touch, with teeth shaped like waves. Salt water beads on it even when dry. Found in Nella Reed’s cargo.